

floppy or CD-ROM and locate the FDISK command. Once located, type in “FDISK /MBR” and hit [Enter]. Wait for the process to complete, and your boot sector should be fixed.

For Windows NT/2000/XP, boot via the bootable CD-ROM and enter the repair console. Here, type in “FIXMBR” and hit [Enter] to restore the boot sector.

► **Problem:** You get an error that says, “Immediately back up your data and replace your hard disk drive. A failure may be imminent.”

Cause: A failure could indeed be imminent. The error is displayed during the boot process only when you have a hard drive that is SMART-enabled. “SMART” stands for “Self-Monitoring Analysis and Reporting Technology,” and is an industry-wide standard for increasing the reliability of hard drives to prevent loss of data.

Solution: When you get such an error, it is advisable to back up the data on your hard drive. If your drive is in the warranty period, it should be immediately sent to the service centre for replacement or repair. As of now, the SMART tool can detect up to 70 per cent of drive errors—the warning should therefore be taken seriously.

► **Problem:** The system refuses to boot after installing a new hard drive.

Cause: The hard drive may not be connected properly, i.e., the data connector and the power connector could be improperly connected.

Solution: When installing a new hard drive, always double-check the connection of the data cable. Pin number one on the motherboard should coincide with pin number one on the hard drive. One edge of the data cable is marked red to indicate it as pin number one.

While connecting it to the drive, make sure the red line coincides with pin number one of the drive and motherboard. Usually, the red line on the cable and the red wire of the power connector will be side by side when connected to the drive—this indicates a proper connection.

► **Problem:** Hard drive letters after C: are pushed ahead when a second drive is attached.